

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced

雅思口语高级

——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 11 Education

Topic 1—Lesson 2(下篇)

A short course



IELTS Speaking Part 2 (10 minutes)

You will be given one minute to prepare to talk about the topic on the task card. You will have to talk for 1-2 minutes, and then the teacher will give you feedback for 2-3mins. (5 minutes)

Describe a short course you took or would like to take.

You should say:

why you took it

what it was

what the exact content of the course was

and **explain what** you learned from the course.



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.3 Here is another model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (5 minutes)

Model 2

Why took it: I have been contemplating taking short summer courses for a long time now, because this is a way to **speed up** my education. I am always looking for loopholes and the quickest and most efficient route to success. I decided to finally enroll in a well talked about and sought out course last summer.

What it was: Every time I tried to enroll in this course, it was always full. I finally **took the initiative** and signed up early. This course was called *Global Geopolitical Conflicts in the 21st century*.

What content: As you may have surmised from the title, this course covered every major and minor conflict over the past century. It focused on the concept of proxy wars and how it affects every minute detail involved in global diplomacy.

What you learned: Passing this course was no simple endeavour. It took all of my mental **fortitude** to grasp all of the variables associated with international politics. I managed to learn a great deal about the underlying mechanisms and causes for conflicts among nations. I also learned that in order to study these root causes one must use both quantitative and qualitative data and then proceed to rigorously test the data against real world scenarios. Above all else I now have a solid foundation and understanding of the reasons why many conflicts occur in the world, which are too many to list here.

IV. IELTS Speaking Part 3 (10 mins)

1. Please answer the following question from Part 3. According to your answer, the teacher will give you feedback on how to improve your organisational skills. (5 minutes)

How to organise your answer in Part 3:

I: Introduction Sentence + P: Points (Point1, Point2...)

What are the benefits of short courses?

I: As far as I am concerned, there are two major benefits people shall gain from taking short courses.

P1: The first benefit lies in the fact that it allows the participant to learn new skills and knowledge that may not be covered in traditional classes. Usually, after grasping some new techniques in short courses, such as cooking and mending machines, a laid-off work may find it easier to be reemployed.

P2: The second benefit would be the fact that it saves people's time, simply because so much information can be condensed into a shorter time span. You don't have to spend an excessive length of time completing a term.

2. You will learn some key words and expressions from these questions. Pay attention to the structure of the underlined sentences, and the words in red. (5 minutes)

Key Words and Models

What other advantages do short courses offer, besides providing new skills and knowledge?

 There are two other advantages of taking short courses in addition to gaining new skills and knowledge. One advantage lies in our brain's innate ability to learn lots of information in a short time. Since short courses are often optimised to teach the largest amount of information possible without overwhelming the student, it stands to reason that this aspect coupled with the amount of time saved is a beneficial characteristic of shorter courses. Another advantage to short courses is that if you have multiple courses, it increases the likelihood of making new friends. That is to say, whenever you begin a new course, you will be able to meet a different group of classmates.

Why do you think retired people might want to take such courses?

 For retired people that take short courses the purpose is not only to learn something new, but also to keep their brain smooth and functioning. Research has shown that learning new skills can increase your brain's capacity to **retain** information and open up new pathways to stimulate neurons, which leads to a healthier brain. Also, for the retired taking shorter courses is much more appealing since they allow for more free time.

V. Summary (5 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

speed up

take the initiative

fortitude

optimise

be condensed into

retain



Key Sentences

This is a way to **speed up** my education.

I finally **took the initiative** and signed up early. This course was called *Global Geopolitical Conflicts in the 21st century*.

Passing this course was no simple endeavour. It took all of my mental **fortitude** to grasp all of the variables associated with international politics.

Since short courses are often **optimised** to teach the largest amount of information possible without overwhelming the student, it stands to reason that this aspect coupled with the amount of time saved is by far the most beneficial characteristic of shorter courses.

The second benefit would be the fact that it saves people's time, simply because so much information can **be condensed into** a shorter time span.

Research has shown that learning new skills can increase your brain's capacity to **retain** information and open up new pathways to stimulate neurons, which leads to a healthier brain.

The next lesson will be **Unit 11 Topic 2 A short course**.